



*The magazine that
improves your game.*

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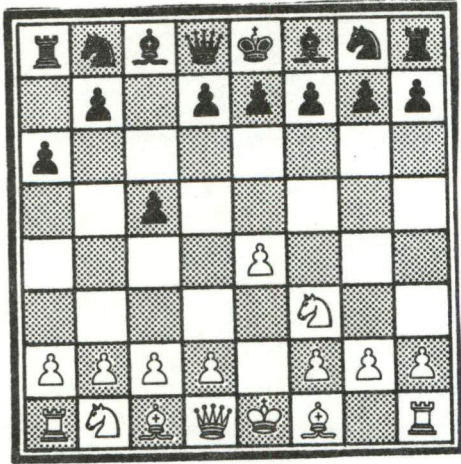
£1.30

the o'kelly

by Michael Basman

The O'Kelly variation is a little known line that frequently overruns a white player who plays too automatically against the Sicilian.

1 e4 c5
2 Nf3 a6



The first sign of the O'Kelly. This pawn plays a vital role in preventing a white knight from reaching b5.

3 d4

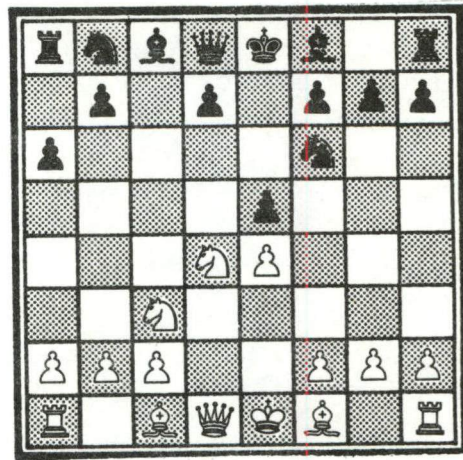
This is the normal response to the Sicilian. White opens up the centre immediately to underline his space advantage. However, there are other moves: 3 c3 could be met by 3...d5 4 exd5 Qxd5 5 d4 e6; or even by the St. George - 3...e6 4 d4 b5 5 Bd3 Bb7.

3 Nc3, which also bypasses the true O'Kelly, could be met by a Kan variation: 3...e6 4 d4 cxd4 5 Nxd4 Qc7. And the same could be said for 3 c4.

3 ... cxd4
4 Nxd4 Nf6

Another point; white cannot play 5 e5 here because of ... Qa5+, winning a pawn.

5 Nc3 e5!



The O'Kelly is revealed in all its glory after this move. The white knight cannot advance to b5 now, and the other advance, 5 Nf5, is met by ...d5!, and black gains a central advantage, since white cannot win the pawn at d5 without losing his knight at f5.

6 Nf3

A retreat which contains an attack on the black pawn at e5, but 6 Nb3 is probably sounder. 6 Nde2 could be met by ...Bb4 or even ...Bc5.

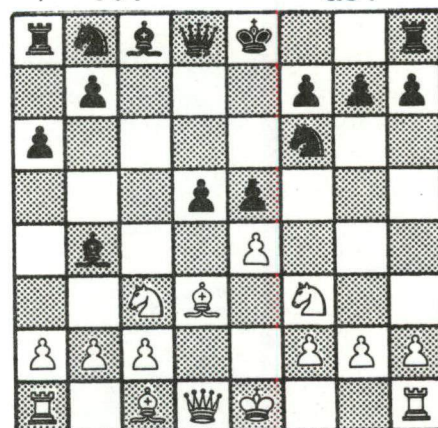
6 ... Bb4!

Black does not even bother to defend his e5 pawn, since he reckons that white will fall too far behind in development after either 7 Nxe5 0-0 (and ...Re8) or 7 Nxe5 Qc7, attacking both knights.

7 Bd3

A natural move, to defend the pawn at e4, and prepare castling, but one that cedes ground immediately. Better chances came from 7 Bc4 or 7 Bd2.

7 ... d5!



It is remarkable in the O'Kelly variation how often this move is playable, which at one stroke eliminates the backward d-pawn which is such a bugbear of the Boleslavsky and Najdorf variations.

White is now threatened by the loss of a piece (by...dxe4) so he cannot play 0-0; nor can he play 8 exd5, which also loses a piece to the pawn fork 8...e4.

8 Nd2 0-0

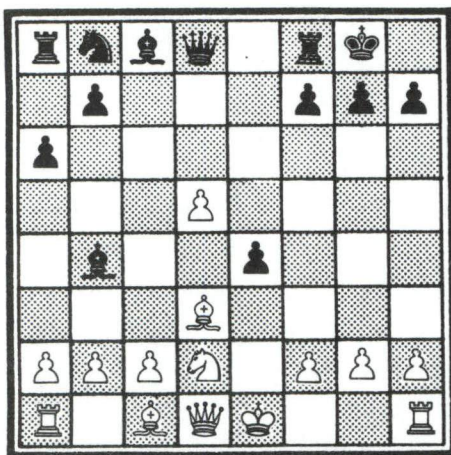
Black could swap off pieces to reach a level ending, but he is playing for the attack.

9 Nxd5

A risky capture; white is trying to avoid doubled pawns at c3, but it would have been safer to have played 9 0-0 here.

9 ... Nxd5

10 exd5 e4!



Once again, the automatic recapture 10...Qxd5 is not the best, because white can hide his king by castling. Now white will lose castling rights if the takes the second pawn (10 Bxe4 Bxd2+ 11 Kxd2; but not 10 Bxe4 Re8? 11 c3! and white escapes).

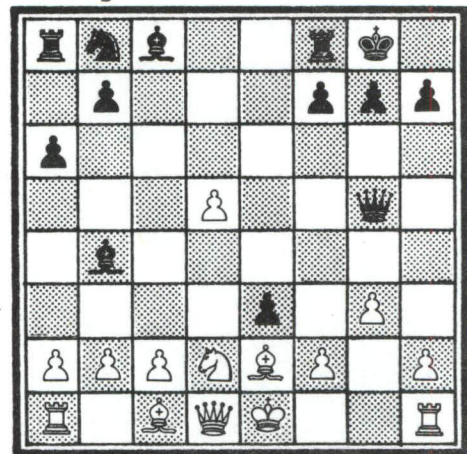
11 Be2

At first sight, it looks better to play 11 Bc4, guarding the pawn at d5. But then black wins a piece with 11...e3! 12 fxe3 Qh4+ 13 g3 Qxc4. So white places the bishop on a safer square.

11 ... Qg5!

And now, if white wants to castle, it will cost him the exchange by ...Bh3.

12 g3 e3!



After this move, white is technically lost, because he will never get his king into safety.

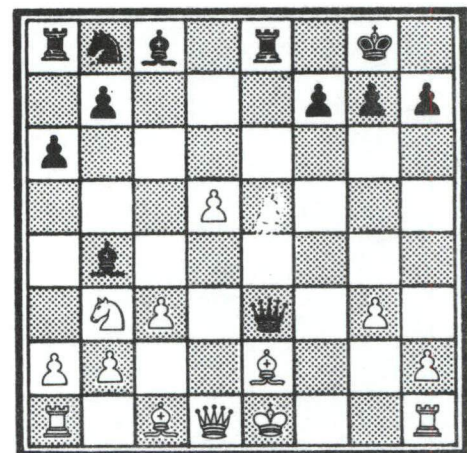
13 fxe3 Qxe3

14 c3

Attempting to push back the black pieces; but the advance is remorseless.

14 ... Re8!

15 Nb3



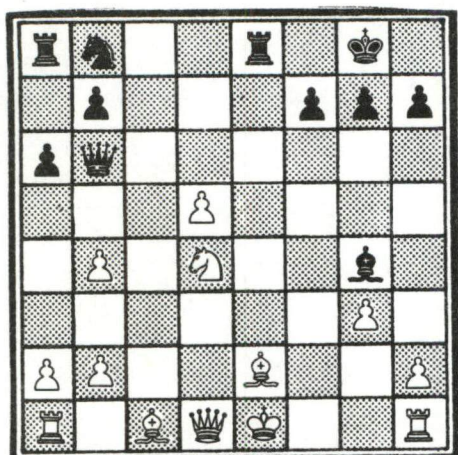
15 cxb4 would have been met by ...Bg4, and 15 Nc4 failed to Bxc3+ 16 bxc3 Qxc3+ 17 Bd2 Qxc4.

15 ... Qb6

Black finally retreats, but he still makes sure that white cannot castle his king out of the centre.

16 cxb4 Bg4

17 Nd4



So far everything looks defended, and white has his extra piece. But black's next move upsets the apple cart...

17 ... Nc6!!

A clearance sacrifice to bring the last black piece into action. If white now plays 18 dxc6 Rad8 paralyses him completely.

In the actual game (D.E. Lloyd v. M. Basman, Hastings Challengers 1965), white played here 18 Ne6!, but after 18...Bxe2 19 Qxe2 Nd4 20 Qd3 Nxe6 21 dxe6 Rxe6+, he was eventually mated on move 36.

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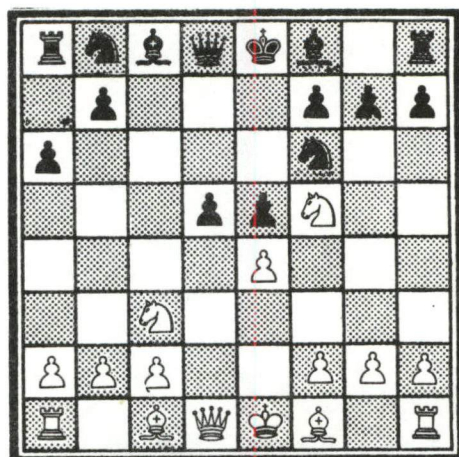
Now we shall look at some recent examples of the variation from amateur games.

White: Ansell

Black: Golechha

London Boys Under 14 championship 1987.

1 e4	c5
2 Nf3	a6
3 d4	cx d4
4 Nxd4	Nf6
5 Nc3	e5
6 Nf5?	d5!



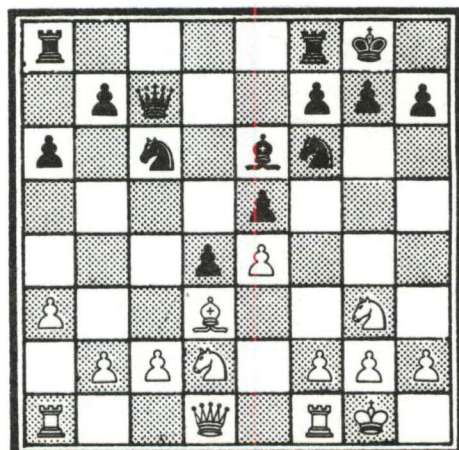
White's incautious knight advance to f5 has allowed black to seize the initiative immediately, and now white must retreat or lose a pawn at e4.

Naturally, 7 Nxd5 Nxd5 8 Qxd5 Qxd5 9 exd5 Bxf5 is no good for white.

7 Ng3	Bb4
8 Bd2	d4
9 Nb1	Bxd2+

Possibly ...Bc5 was better here.

10 Nxd2	Nc6
11 a3	0-0
12 Bd3	Be6
13 0-0	Qc7

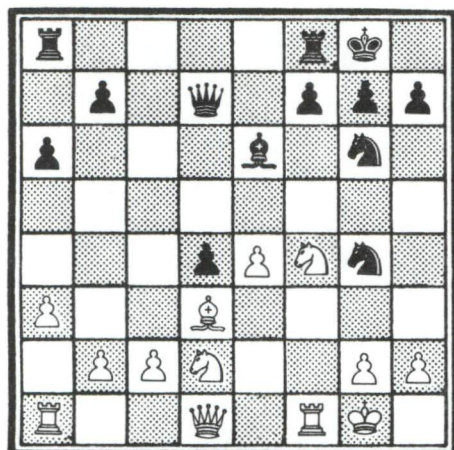


Black is already fully developed, and enjoys a space advantage in the middle of the board.

14 Qe2	Ne7
15 Qd1	

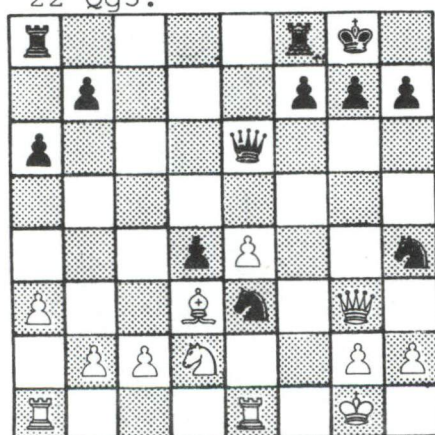
An aimless two moves with the queen. White decides he wants a knight on e2 after all, so he can prepare the thrust f4. But his position is not likely to withstand the opening up of the game.

15 ... Ng6
16 Ne2 Qd7
17 f4 exf4
18 Nxf4 Ng4



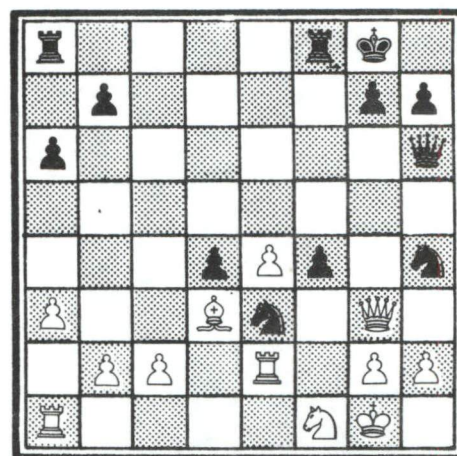
Black is heading for the e3 square, weakened by white's f4 advance.

19 Nxe6 Qxe6
20 Qf3 Ne3
21 Rfe1 Nh4
22 Qg3!



A good reply, which prevents black from playing ...Nxe2, because of the reply 23 Re2, followed by Rxe2.

22 ... Qh6
Now threatening ...Nxe2.
23 Re2 f5!
24 Nf1 f4!



Black's pressure on white's king side is becoming ominous.

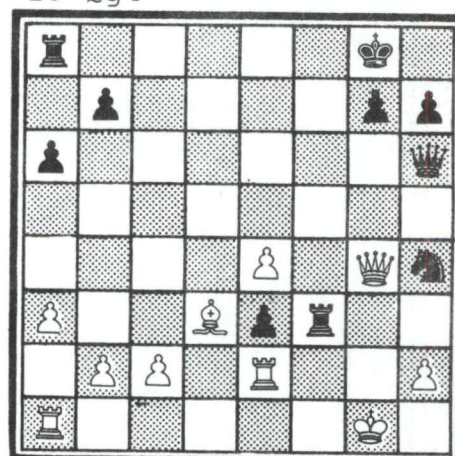
25 Qh3 f3!

26 Nxe3 dxe3

...fxe2 looks even stronger.

27 gxf3 Rxf3

28 Qg4



In this position, which looks so hopeless for white, black has to be careful not to overreach with his attack.

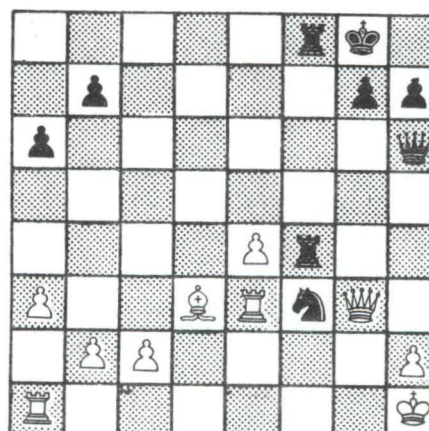
28 ... Rf4

29 Qg3 Nf3+

30 Kh1 Raf8

31 Rxe3?

White could have fought on with 31 Rf1.



31 ... Nxh2!

White had set a trap here, hoping black would fall in by playing 31 ...Rg4??! 32 Bc4+ Kh8 33 Rxf3! (not 33 Qxg4?? Qxh2 mate) Rxg3 34 Rxf8++.

However, the move black plays completely demolishes white's position.

32 Qh3

If 32 Qxh2 Rh4 pins the white queen.

32 ... Rh4

33 Bc4+ Kh8

White resigns.

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And now a game where white puts up somewhat sterner opposition.

White: N.Callow

Black: A.Panchapagesan

Surrey Under 18 championship

February 1988

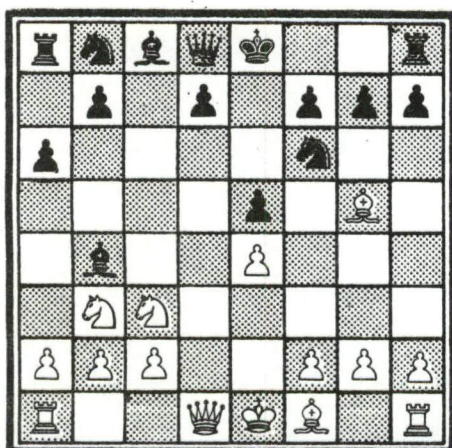
1 e4	c5
2 Nf3	a6
3 d4	cx d4
4 Nxd4	Nf6
5 Nc3	e5
6 Nb3	

As previously stated, this retrat is stronger than Nf3. It reinforces the weak queen side.

6 ... Bb4

It was also possible to play à la Najdorf with ...d6....Be6.

7 Bg5

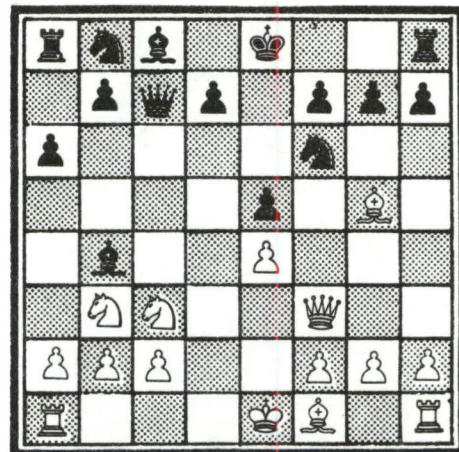


A new idea, which leads to interesting play. 7 Bd2 is solid.

7 ... Qc7

8 Qf3

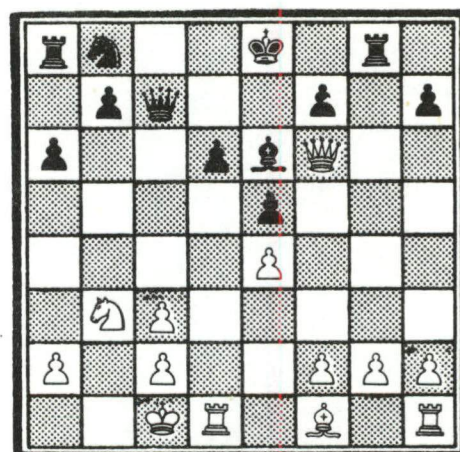
White would lose a pawn after 8 Bxf6 Bxc3+ 9 bxc3 Qxc3+ & gxf6.



8 ... d6?

Remarkably enough, 8... d5! is still powerful. If 9 exd5 e4 10 Qe3 Nxd5 11 Qxe4+ Be6; or if 9 Bxf6 dxe4 10 Qxe4 Bxc3+ 11 bxc3 Qxc3+ 12 Kf1 gxf6 black is better

9 Bxf6	gxf6
10 0-0-0	Bxc3
11 Qxf6	Rg8
12 bxc3	Be6



White is a pawn ahead in an unbalanced position where both kings have shaky pawn coverage.

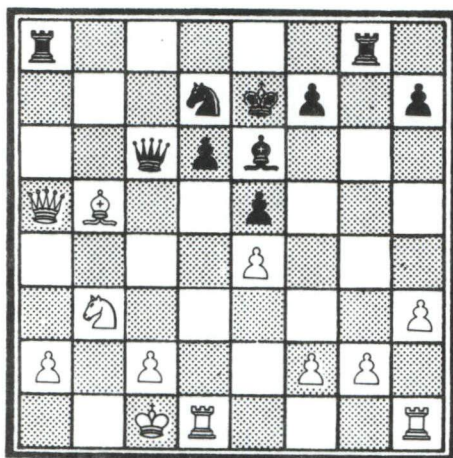
13 c4	Nd7
14 Qh6	Nf8
Protecting the h-pawn.	
15 Qd2	Ke7

In the absence of the black squared bishop, the king must do the job of defending d6. At least black does not have to worry about having a bad bishop!

16 Qa5

Not having thought up a clear plan, white begins to thrash about. The pawn advance g3 with f4 to follow would have given better chances.

16 ...	b6
17 Qb4	Nd7
18 h3	b5!?
19 Qa5	Qc6
20 cxb5	axb5
21 Bxb5	



The pawns have come away from the queen side, and black attempts to launch an attack on the white king. In fact though, black would have done best to swap the queens here by ...Rxa5 22 Bxc6 Rxa2. In the ensuing struggle with queens on, white's attack is the more dangerous.

21 ...	Qxe4?!
22 Qc7?	

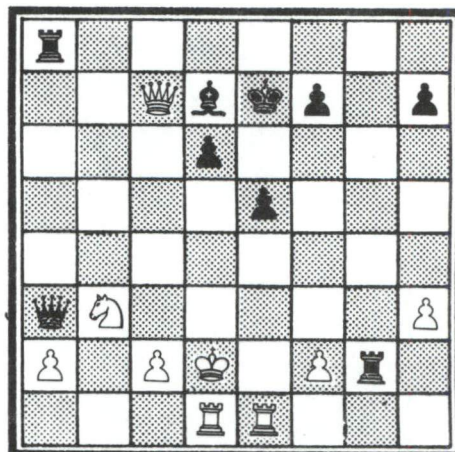
Here white misses the very strong move 22 Qd2!, which also attacks the d6 square. In that case, though, black does not have the defence ...Qb4.

22 ...	Qb4!
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Holds everything, and the game now turns in black's favour.

23 Bxd7	Bxd7
---------	------

24 Rhel	Qa3+
25 Kd2	Rxg2



White's ship is leaking both port and starboard.

26 Re2	Rc8
27 Qb7	Qb2
28 Rcl	Qc3+
29 Kdl	Rgl+

White resigns.

.....

And one more for luck.

White: M.Jacob
Black: A.Panchapagesan
London Under 14 championship

1 e4 c5 2 Nf3 a6 3 d4 cxd4
4 Nxd4 Nf6 5 Nc3 e5 6 Nf3
Bb4 7 Qd3 0-0 8 Bd2 Bxc3
9 Bxc3 d5 10 0-0-0 Nxe4 11
Be1 Be6 12 h4 (12 Nxe5 fails
to Qg5+) Nd7 13 Kbl Ndc5
14 Qe3 d4 15 Qa3 Qd5 16 Ng5
h6 17 Nxe4 Nxe4 18 f3 Nc5
19 g4 Bxg4 20 Be2 Bf5 21 Bb4
Rfc8 22 Rd2 a5 23 Bxc5 Qxc5
24 Qxc5 Rxc5 25 Rcl Rac8
26 Bd3 Bxd3 27 Rxd3 b5 28
f4 f6 29 Rd2 b4 30 fxe5 fxe5
31 b3 Rf8 32 Rh1 Rf4 33 Kb2
Rd5 34 h5 e4 35 Rhd1 e3 36
Rd3 Kf7 White resigns.

.....

VICTOR MATHIAS annotates

(White:Victor.Black:Alan)

1. P-Q4

tiring of 1. P-K4 which, against Alan, invariably faces the French Defence.

1. ... N-KB3

2. P-QB4 P-K3

3. N-KB3 not 3. N-QB3, which might

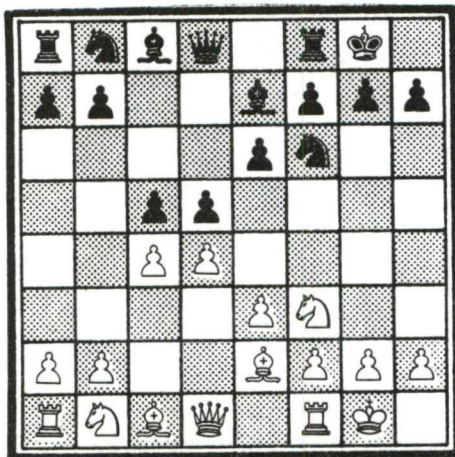
provoke the Nimzo-Indian Defence (3. ... B-N5) Are we already out of the books?

3. ... P-Q4

4. P-K3 P-B4

5. B-K2 B-K2

5. O-O O-O



Perfect symmetry. Alan and I have been here before. A typically dull opening position which 1. P-Q4 can easily give rise to.

7. R-K1

In the short-term, I

came to regret this move (perhaps the rook should have stayed where it was to guard f2; perhaps it should have waited till space was made for it on d1); but in fact in the long term I retained control of the e-file for the rest of the game.

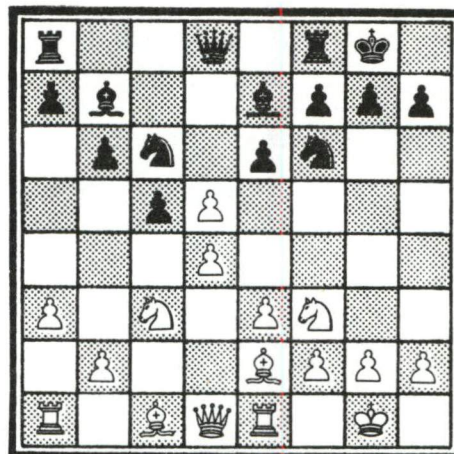
7. ... N-B3

8. P-QR3 Again, this move gives little short-term benefit; but in the long run it stands my QRP in a useful spot where it denies Alan the use of b4. The move also offers me the possibility of putting my queen securely on c2 if I wish to do so later.

8. ... P-QN3 Alan sees that his QB has little future on its home diagonal.

9. N-B3 B-N2

10. PxQP



Let battle commence! Alan, alas, falters at the first hurdle. He tries to be too clever by half. The simple recapture on d5 by N or P would have been OK.

10. ... BPxP??

11. PxN

Alan must now go into a substantial material deficit. Why? Because I threaten a piece next move and he does not.

11. ... BxP

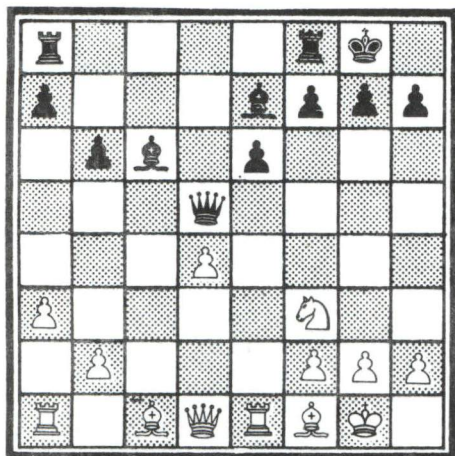
12. PxP

Alan is a straight piece down and I have the open e-file for my rook. The game seems virtually over already, but I assure you that it isn't!

12. ... N-Q4 Perhaps slightly punch-drunk, Alan offers a new exchange of minor pieces which I snap up because (a) the player in the lead is supposed to welcome exchanges and simplification and (b) this particular exchange brings Alan's queen into the central open spaces where it can be fired at.

13. NxN QxN

14. B-B1



Apparently very defensive play from white in so strong and tempting a position; but the move (a) protects against a mate on g2 (b) thereby releases my knight and (c) opens the e-file for my rook.

14. ... QR-B1

15. B-KB4 KR-Q1 Alan brings both his rooks quietly and forcefully into the game in a way he has often failed to do in previous tussles.

16. B-QR6! This more or less forces another exchange (favourable to me) as Alan's only alternative is a humiliating retreat of his QR back to its home square.

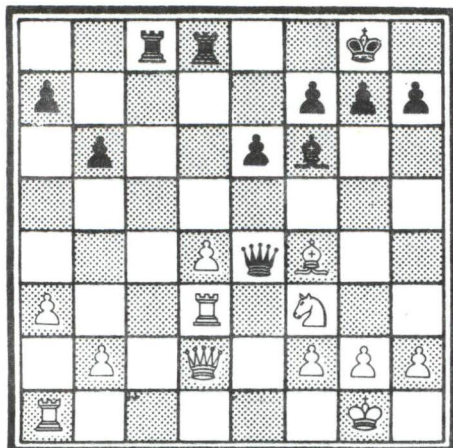
16. ... B-N2

17. BxB QxB and Alan no longer has any substantial threat to g2

18. R-K3 B-B3 I am now vulnerable on the d-file and Alan naturally tries to capitalise on this.

19. R-Q3 Q-K5

20. Q-Q2

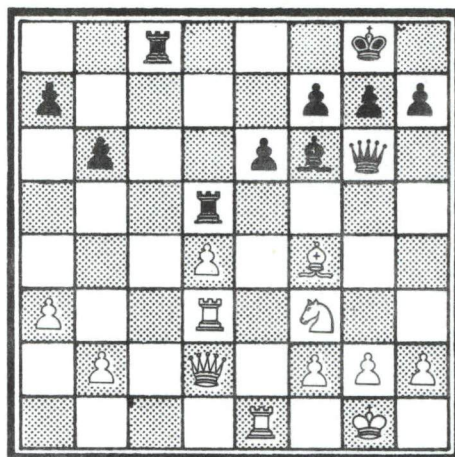


A handy move affording me many possibilities. It defends my bishop, gets my queen off the back rank (thus defending b2), & lets my

queen's rook into the game with a flourish either on d1 or e1. As so often in our past encounters, Alan's queen begins to look uncomfortable.

20. ... R-Q4 This looks suspect, shutting off one of the escape-routes for the black queen merely in order to increase the pressure on my queen pawn.

21. R-K1 Q-N3



Now I must think hard. I want to put one of my minor pieces on e5, but which should move there first, bishop or knight? My aim is twofold, (i) to force another exchange and (ii) to entice Alan's f-pawn to advance which will weaken his e-pawn and his defence of the king. One important feature of this position is not immediately apparent. Alan, I think, had noticed it. I, at this stage, had not. It is that my IQP is pinned. If it takes anything on e5 then I lose my d3 rook, and my queen is attacked. Very nasty for me!

22. N-K5

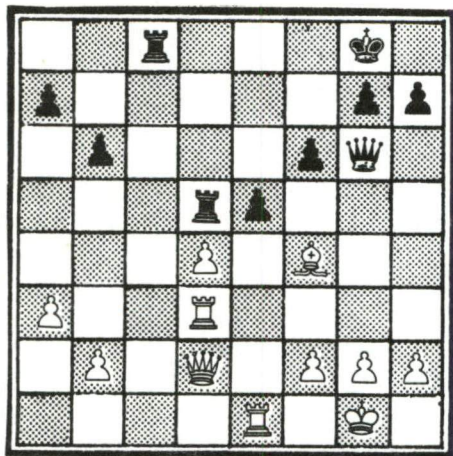
The better choice, I think. It is more forcing.

22. ... BxN

23. BxB P-B3 what I was scheming for, but I am presented with another difficult decision. Should I (a) give Alan back some material with 24. BxP, hoping for ... PxP?? when his queen is lost to 25. R-KN3!! or (b) retire my bishop to f4, or (c) bring it back to g3? (Note also, in this present set-up, that my rook is in a sense 'pinned' against the c2 square. If, for example, I play R-KB3 at some stage, then Alan has the powerful reply ...R-B7! So, all in all, Alan has a fair amount of subtle pressure on me to compensate for his deficit.)

24. B-B4 I decide a sacrifice of the bishop gets me nowhere, but I want to leave g3 vacant for my rook later on, if I can.

24. ... P-K4!



I can't play 25. PxP (see above), so this is a fine advance by Alan.

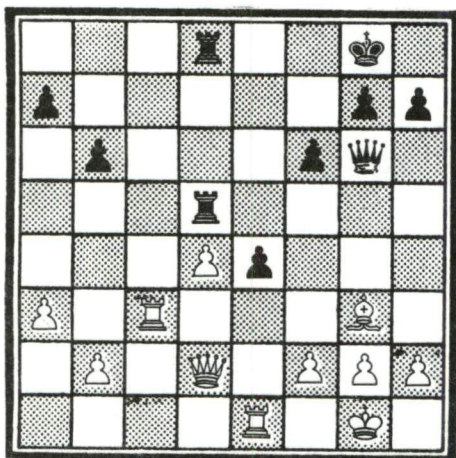
25. B-N3
wasted a tempo.

So my last move

25. ... P-K5 On it comes, remorselessly.

26. R-QB3 I would welcome an exchange of rooks, because such an exchange would end Alan's threat to my c2 square.

26. ... R(1)-Q1



An excellent sidestep, and a wise rejection of the exchange just offered. My QP and my c3 rook now become very embarrassed. Alan begins to climb back into the game and obtain some real compensation for his piece deficit.

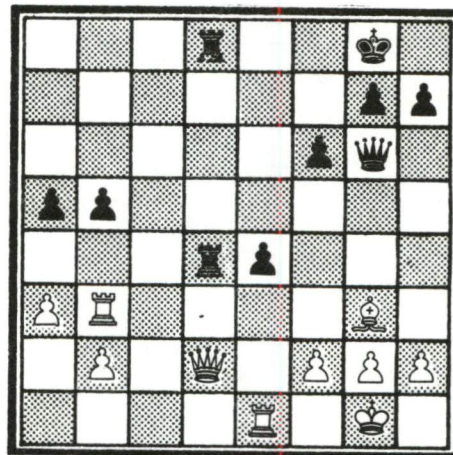
27. R-P4 At this point I reckoned I could hold on to the QP.

27. ... P-N4 Alan thinks differently.

28. R-N4 P-QR4 ... and Alan is right. I had been silly enough to forget that, even at this advanced stage in the game, his QRP could move 2 squares forward in one go.

29. R-N3 Where else?

29. ... RXP



Alan has clawed back a pawn. Or has he? My queen must move. It can move and at the same time capture Alan's QRP. But should it? Will my queen be too far removed from the scene of action if I move it to a5? Will my pieces then become too disconnected??

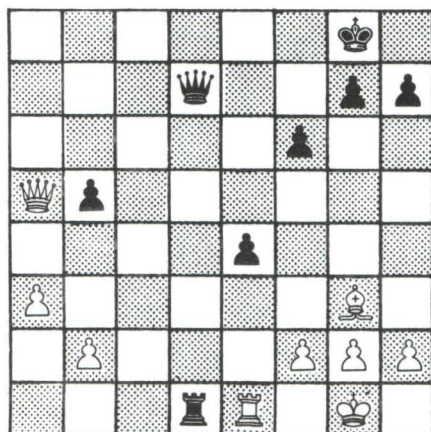
30. QxP I decide to take the risk. True, I face dangers of a back-rank mate; but black attempts at aggression, such as ... R-Q8, don't work as long as my queen continues to guard e1. Also, I now threaten 31. RxNp.

30. ... Q-K1 This looks slightly craven; but it guards the menaced b-pawn, and Alan's back-rank rook (in case he decides to undouble on the open d-file). Apart from being a backward step, which is not of itself necessarily bad, the move created a pin on one of Alan's major weapons, his e-pawn.

31. R(3)-K3 Returning this rook actively into the game. I am now, thanks to doubled rooks on the e-file, fairly safe against any danger of a back-row mate.

31. ... R-Q8 Alan's attack starts to crumble, because my last move made it possible for me safely to swap off a pair of rooks.

32 RxR RxRch
33 R-K1 Q-Q2



34 Q-R8ch!

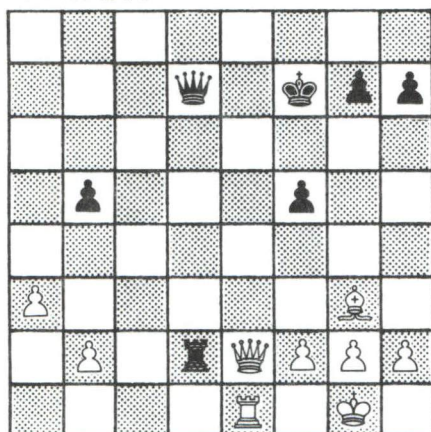
Which enables me to capture Alan's key KP and protect my back rank rook at the same time.

34 ... K-B2
35 QxP P-B4

Alan embarks on a last ditch offensive, and a strong one! My queen must stay on the e-file, or I'm mated.

36 Q-K2 R-Q7

With this move, is Alan about to snatch victory from the jaws of defeat?



I must think and think again. 37 R-Q1 loses, of course, to ...RxRch. So my queen must be shifted. But where to? 37 Q-B1 looks safe enough but unenterprising. 37 Q-B3 leaves me some chances of counter attack, but leaves my rook looking very solitary in its defensive role. 37 Q B1 would enable me to play 38 P-B3, to link my bishop to the rook, and in the event of Alan giving check with his queen on d4, I could retire my king to h1. Queen is well and truly SKEWERED !

But in all these variations I must wave goodbye to my b-pawn and allow Alan the opportunity to put his queen and rook on the seventh rank. In desperation, I begin to consider 37 Q-R5ch. It would have worked out but for one drawback: 37 K-B1 offers Alan the perfect get out. Ought I to play the check anyway, take a chance on Alan not playing ...K-B1, and resign if he does? (This comment is quite incomprehensible. White is a piece ahead, and black has virtually no compensation after 37 Q-R5ch K-B1 38 P-KR3. - Editor)

I returned to pondering 37 Q-B3 and realised that by means of ...R-Q6 Alan could chase my queen backwards and forwards to get a draw. But a draw is better for me than resigning, isn't it? So-

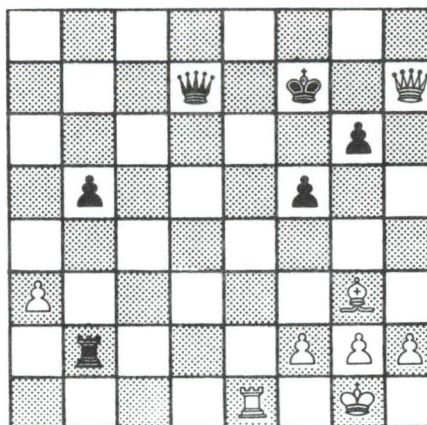
37 Q-B3 RxNP?

A losing move, as we worked out together afterwards. Either ...R-Q6 (see above) or ...P-N3 saves Alan from the prettty finish with which I can now round off the game.

38 Q-R5ch!!

The point is that with Alan's rook off the d file, he can no longer retreat his king to B1. Why not? Because of 39 B-Q6ch!! Isn't that beautiful? Alan's queen cannot take my bishop and defend against my mating threats on e8. Here, I must admit that I didn't notice all the venom which my move 38 bore. I had merely thought it assured me of the exchange of queens, after 38...P-N3 39 QxRPch.

38 ... P-N3
39 QxRPch!! Resigns.



But Alan saw straight away that his

Alan v. Victor Nov. 1987

1 P-K4 P-QB4

2 N-KB3 P-Q3

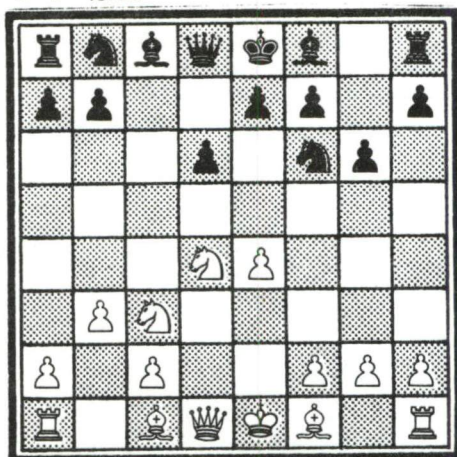
3 P-Q4 PxP

4 NxP N-KB3

5 N-QB3 P-KN3

The Sicilian Dragon

6 P-QN3



This is a very weakening move against the Dragon, considering that the bishop at g7 will be firing along the central black diagonal.

6 ... B-N2

7 R-N1?

Positionally, a very weak move. The QR is going to do nothing on that file.

7 ... P-QR3

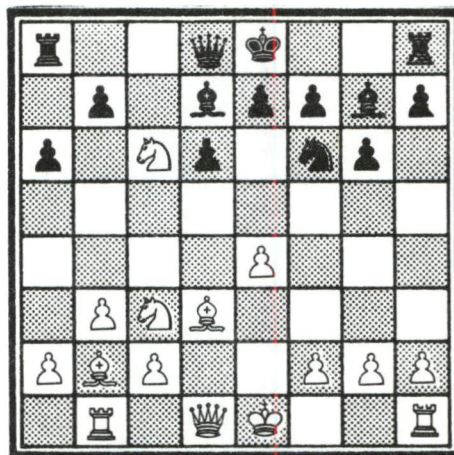
As a result of Alan's 7th move, I have plenty of time to play what I'd describe as the Najdorf Dragon Defence!

8 B-N2 B-Q2

9 B-Q3 N-B3

...P-K4 here would drive back Alan's central knight and block the diagonal on which he has just placed his queen's bishop; but my own fianchettoed bishop would then face a dim future. (Anyway, "closed" games are anathema to me and, I think, to Alan too.)

10 NxN



...PxN here would hinder two well known themes for black in the Sicilian, viz, the open c file, and a pawn advance along the b file. (However, capturing with the pawn brings the black pawn towards the centre and maybe better-Ed.)

10 ... BxN

11 Q-K2 R-QB1

12 O-O O-O

13 P-B4

Alan's favourite strategy: roll forward the king side pawns, even at the cost of his king's safety. I believe we're in for another exciting struggle!

13 ... N-Q2

Withdrawing the knight from the firing line of Alan's advancing pawns.

14 N-Q1

Too deep for me this one!

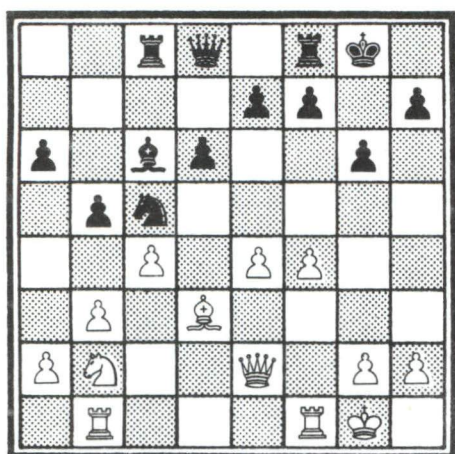
14 ... BxB

15 NxB P-QN4!

Now Alan is stuck with a knight that looks pretty useless, and that blocks in his queens rook!

16 P-B4 N-B4!

My own knight, by contrast, is now sweetly placed. An exchange of pawns is going to open the queenside even further for my rook.



17 PxP PxP

18 QR-K1

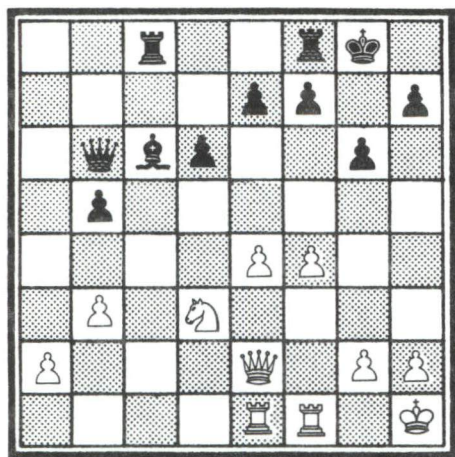
18 BxP would have been answered by ...BxP. The move Alan chose instead underlines the fact that the rook had been put on the wrong square when he first moved it.

18 ... Q-N3!

Preventing BxP, and at the same time threatening a discovered check which would win me a piece.

19 K-R1 NxB

20 NxN



Alan's knight, although better placed than it used to be, is still not very active.

20 ... P-N5

Vacating b5, with the aim of putting my bishop there to thunderously good effect!

21 P-B5

Alan probably saw my intentions but ignored them and tried for counterplay with the rolling of his pawns on the king side.

21 ...

B-N4

We continue to proceed separately with our schemes.

22 Q-Q2

Alan's queen sidles out of the pin, but of course his knight remains pinned to the king rook on the back rank.

22 ...

BxN

Drawing Alan's queen off its dangerous diagonal (leading to my weak point at h6) and forcing it instead onto a square where I can attack it with a gain of tempo.

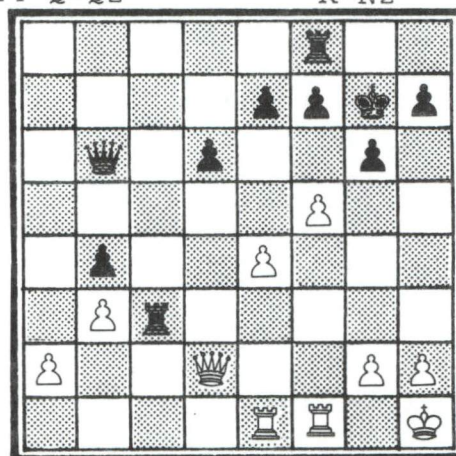
23 QxB

R-B6

Yet again, as black in a Sicilian, my textbook threats arise along the open c file!

24 Q-Q2

K-N2



Absolutely necessary, I think, since I had no other way of preventing 25 Q-R6.

25 Q-N5

Threatening to take my king pawn next move—a threat that is fairly easily parried; and this is the 4th of 5 successive queen moves by Alan, which cannot be a good thing, but is characteristic of his style of play.

25 ...

P-B3

26 Q-N4

Reluctant to release the pin on my g pawn.

26 ...

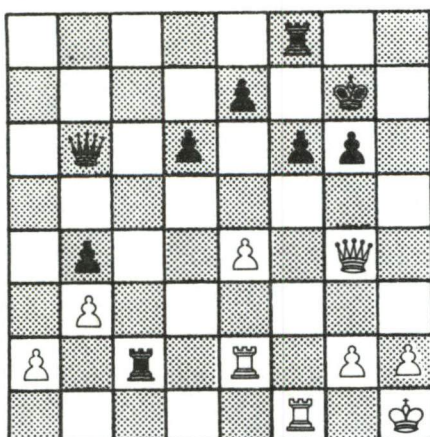
R-B7

The fact that Alan's rooks are still so inactive gives me time to occupy his seventh rank.

27 PxP

PxP

28 R-K2



Offering an exchange of rooks, which I was just leaning forward to accept without much thought, when I hesitated. I'd had a glimpse of something better. (Can you see what it was?) "The trouble with these clever moves," I said to Alan, as he sat waiting for me to decide what to do, "is that there's always something wrong with them." "Yes, he replied, "there usually is..." (in the tone of a player, like myself, who is often tempted to be too clever by half). When I finally made my move, however, Alan made only one comment. "Brilliant" he remarked.

28 ... Q-R3!

Threatening mate in one, if Alan takes my rook. This threat wins Alan's QRP, and also menaces the capture of his rook itself, on e2.

29 R(2)-K1

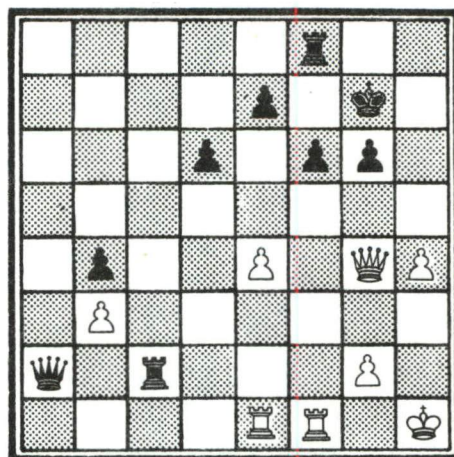
After much thought. This, I think, is the only move enabling Alan to retain his pair of rooks; but I think a doubling of his rooks would have been better (on the f-file, rather than the e-file).

29 ... QxP

At this point we adjourned the game for a week.

When we resumed, Alan admitted to me that he considered his position very dicey, but I don't know that it was dicey enough for him to have justified choosing his next move:

30 P-R4



Abandoning his b pawn to its fate and throwing everything into a king side attack. Alan aims at my pinned g pawn, but the weakness of his idea is that I have time BOTH to capture his b pawn AND bring back my queen to the defence of my pinned g pawn.

30 ... QxP

31 P-R5 Q-B2

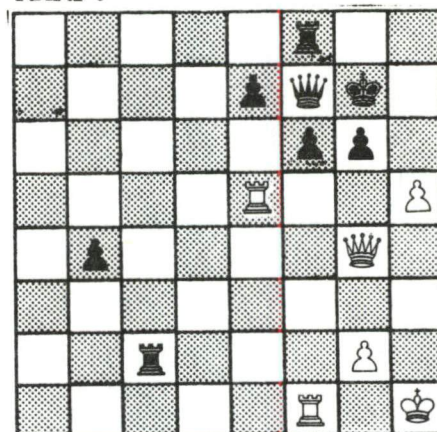
The defences around my king are now very sound. Alan is two pawns down. I have a passed pawn on the queen side. And, later on, I'm going to be able to exploit Alan's grave weakness on the h-file.

32 P-K5

This is beginning to look like a kamikaze act! Can Alan have planned these sacrifices at home, so as to open lines towards my king?

32 ... QPxP

33 RxKP!



Alan's best move of the game! Yes, perhaps all this has been planned. My g pawn AND my f pawn are both pinned. And Alan has the interesting threat of 34 RxKP QxR 35 QxPch, which looks fearsome over the board,

but in fact is probably not good enough even to draw. I decided, not being able to analyse that far ahead, to try and thwart Alan's plan, if this was indeed what it was. But how? I thought for an awfully long time. Meanwhile, on the other side of the board, Alan - hawk-like - stared fixedly at the area around my king. I could defend my e-pawn by ...R-B2, or ...R-K1, but both these moves seemed to surrender the initiative entirely to Alan. At length, I found a move of the kind I sought: more of a counter-attack than a defence...

33 ... R-B5!

34 Q-R3

I think that Q-N3, maintaining the pin along the g-file, would have been better.

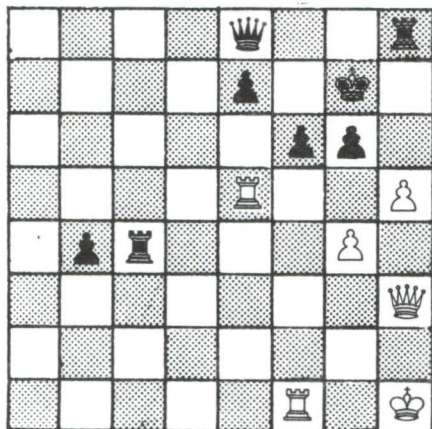
34 ... R-KR1

Threatening to pin and win Alan's queen.

35 P-N4

More or less forced, if Alan wishes to bolster his RP, but of course his king's defences are now practically non-existent.

35 ... Q-K1!



A little move, but oh what a powerful one! I threaten checks on c6 or a8, AND by removing the pin on my f-pawn I also threaten sudden death to Alan's rook at e5.

36 R-K2

Again, pretty well forced; to save said rook and put it where

it can block my checks against the white king.

With the withdrawal of white's rook from e5, his rook pawn is now effectively en prise; but might I spoil my whole game by taking it? The g-file would then be opened against my king. This was what I had to think about next...

36 ... PxP!

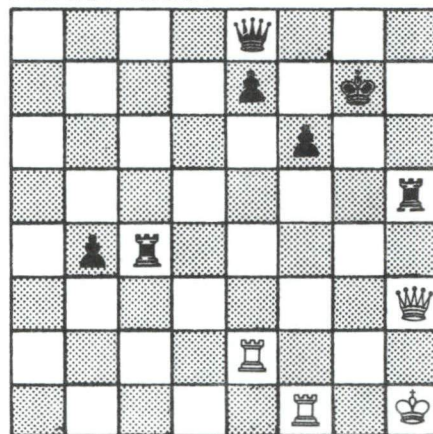
Yes, I calculate that it's OK.

37 PxP?

No, I think pushing the white g-pawn forward, or even leaving it there was safer. I'm not sure. Probably Alan's position is too far gone now for it to matter.

37 ... RxP

I am still in a little bit of danger over my e-pawn, and Alan now wins back a pawn by a simple demonstration that my queen is overburdened.



38 RxKPch!

QxR

39 QxR

Alan is frightfully near to mating me now, but I can get my final attack in first.

39 ... Q-K5ch!

And if Alan's king stays on the h-file, I play...Q-R5ch, exchanging queens with check, to leave me a won position of R & 2 pawns against a rook.

40 Q-B3?

Now I can swap queens; but I have something better.

40 ... Q-R5ch!!

41 K-N1

R-KN5ch

42 Resigns (He loses his queen).

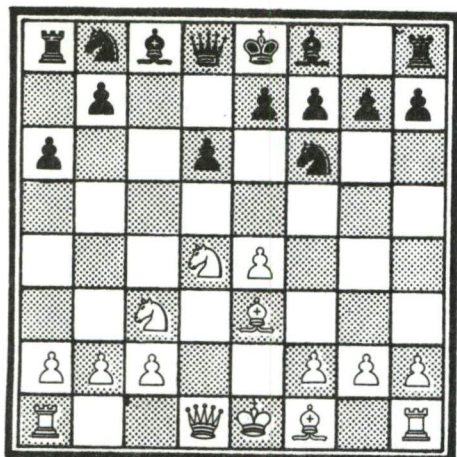
GAMES OF THE LONDON UNDER 14 CHESS CHAMPION

White: A. Panchapagesan

Black: H. Sin

LONDON Under 14 Game 3

1. e4 c5
2. Nf3 d6
3. d4 cxd4
4. Nxd4 Nf5
5. Nc3 a6
6. Be3

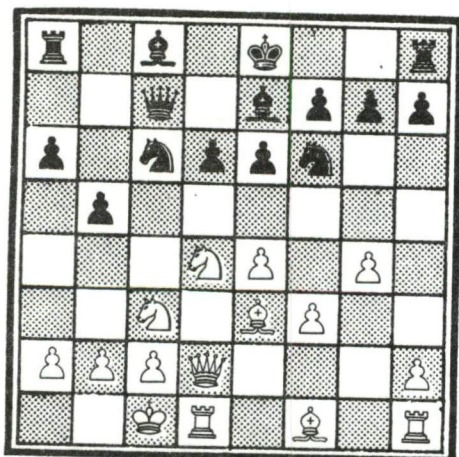


This is the anti-Najdorf variation of the Sicillian defence. With the white pieces, I have had great success in this opening.

6. ... e6
7. f3

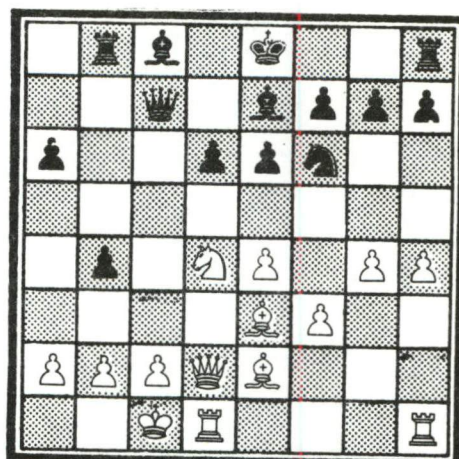
With this move, white overprotects his e4 pawn and prepares a kingside attack with g4 and h4.

7. ... Nc6
8. Qd2 Be7
9. O-O-O Qc7
10. g4 b5



My opponent is trying to create an attack against my king by means of b4, Bd7 and Rc8 using the open c-file.

11. h4 b4
12. Nce2 Nxd4
13. Nxd4 Rb8 defending his pawn on b4.
14. Be2

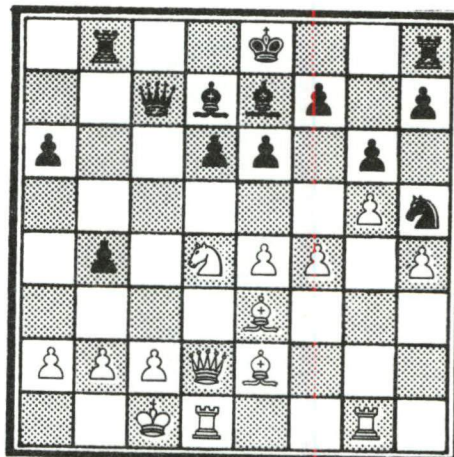


Now I have completed my development and I am preparing to attack - g5, h5, g6 and so on.

14. ... Bd7
15. g5 Nh5

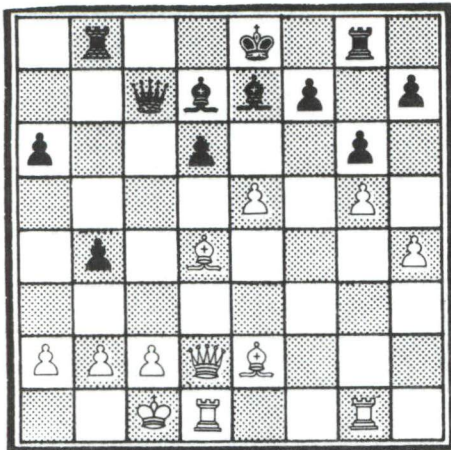
I feel that black is not doing anything in this position whereas I have ideas which will become clear in due course.

16. Rhg1 g6
17. f4!



I am now threatening to play f5 with decisive effect as my opponent cannot play gxf5 because of Bxh5. He now found what, in my opinion, is the only move,

17. ... Nxf4!
18. Bxf4 e5 forking my knight and bishop
19. Be3 exd4
20. Bxd4 Rg8
21. e5!



If 21. ... dxe5, 22. Bxe5! Qxe5
23. Qxd7+ Kf8 24. Rge1 gives me a dangerous initiative.

21. ... Be6
22. exd6 Bxd6

With 22. exd6 I have opened up the e-file for my rook. His king is now very exposed on e8.

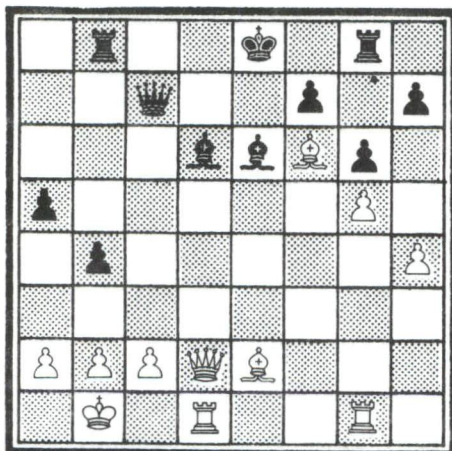
23. Kb1

This move stops Bxa2

23. ... a5

His idea is to play a4 and b3 but he is a bit late.

24. Bf6

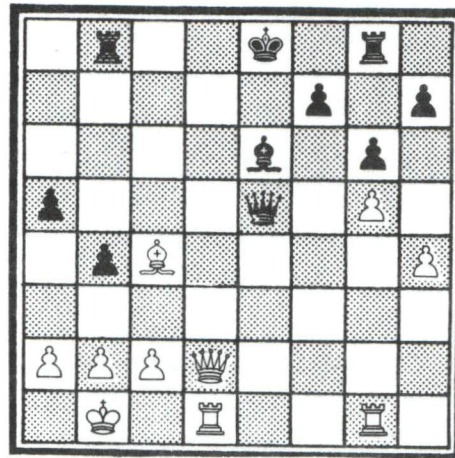


threatening his bishop on d6.

24. ... Be5
25. Bxe5 Qxe5

Now comes the thunderbolt

26. Be4!!

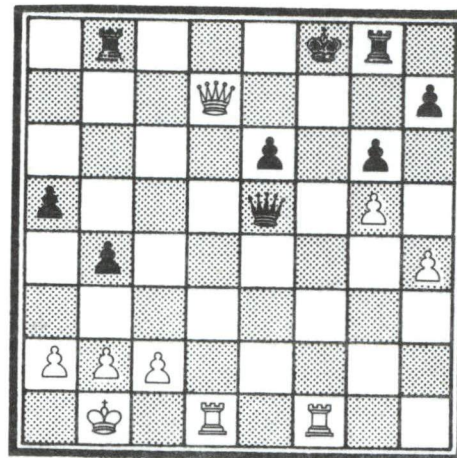


If 26. ... Bxc4, 27. Rge1 wins the black queen. The threat now is Bxe6 fxe6, Qxd7+, Kf8, Rgf1+ winning. There is no defence apart from losing material.

26. ... Ke7
27. Bxe6 fxe6

If 27. ... Qxe6 28. Rge1 winning the queen
If 27. ... Rgd8, 28. Bd5 and white has won a piece. The rest is easy now.

28. Qd7+ Kf8
29. Rgf1+ winning the black queen



29. ... Qf5
30. Rxf5+ exf5
31. Rd6 Rg7
32. Rf6+ Kg8
33. Qe6+ Kh8
34. Rf7 Rd8 threatening Rd1++
35. b3 Rxf7
36. Qxf7 Rd1+
37. Kb2 Rh1?

If 37. ... Rd8, 38. Qf6+ wins the rook but it is better than the text.

38. Qf8++ My first memorable win of the tournament.

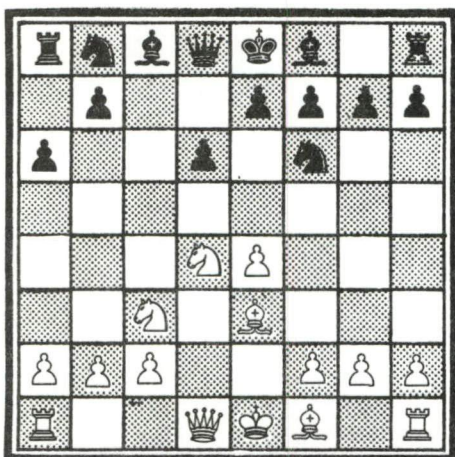
White: A. Panchapagesan

Black: Selim

LONDON Under 14 Game 6

1. e4 c5
2. Nf3 d6
3. d4 cxd4
4. Nxd4 Nf6
5. Nc3 a6
6. Be3

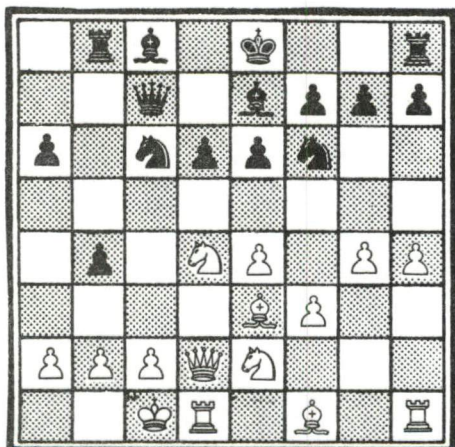
As in my game against H. Sin, I played the anti-Najdorf variation of the Sicilian defence. Selim and H. Sin are coached by the same person and I was sure that Selim had seen my game against H. Sin and he and his coach might have found an improvement, but I was not afraid.



6. ... e6
7. f3 Be7
8. Qd2 Nc6
9. g4

I played this move as a warning to my opponent what was going to be thrown at him. If he castles, his king is only subject to exposure - h4, g5, h5 and g6.

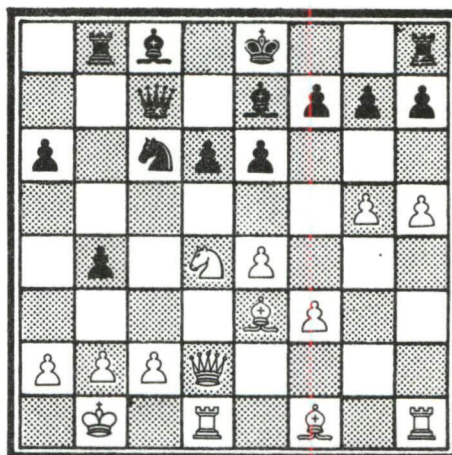
9. ... Qc7
10. O-O-O b5
11. h4 b4
12. Nce2 Rb8 defending his pawn.



13. Kb1 Nd7
14. Nxc6 Qxc6
15. Nd4 Qc7
16. g5 Ne5

As in my game with H. Sin, my opponent has not got a plan while I am threatening to advance my g and h pawns with decisive effect.

17. h5 Nc6?

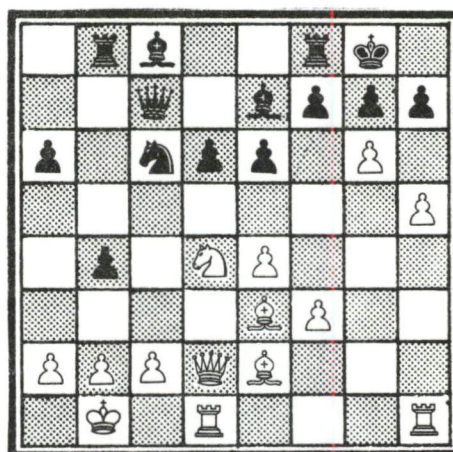


I think this move is pointless. He is letting me get on with my attack without a fight.

18. Be2 to connect my rooks
18. ... O-O

Selim thinks he has adequate defences but he is wrong.

19. g6!



If 19. ... hg, 20. h6! opening up black's kingside.

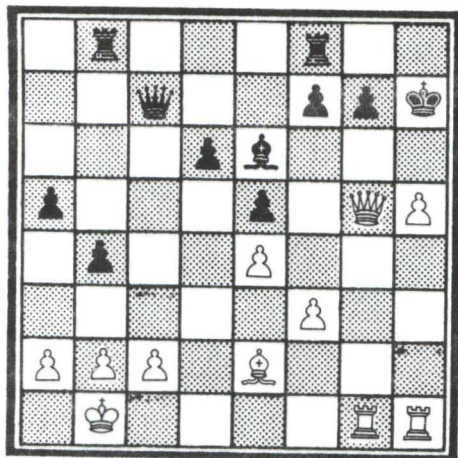
If 19. ... fg, 20. hg again opening up black's kingside.

If 19. ... h6, 20. Nxc6 Qxc6 21. Bxh6 gxh6 22. Qxh6 with a mating attack.

19... Nxd4
 20. gxh7 Kxh7
 21. Bxd4 e5
 22. Be3 a5
 23. Bg5!

This threatens Bxe7 and Qxd6

23. ... Bxg5
 24. Qxg5 Be6
 25. Rdg1 threatening mate on g7



25. ... Rg8

Now comes a lovely finish. In this position white could play 26. Qg6+ and if fxg6 27. hxg6+ Bh3 28. Rxh3 is mate. Unfortunately, after 26. Qg6+, black can play 26. ... Kh8 where white has nothing. My idea is to make my queen and bishop on e2 able to give mate on h7. I did it like this.

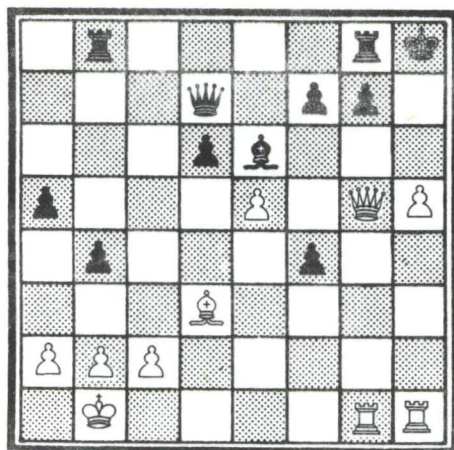
26. f4!! exf4

If he did not take the pawn, I would have played 27. f5! and 28. h6.

27. e5! Kh8

If 27. ... dxe5, 28. Qg6+!! Kh8, 29. Bd3

28. Bd3 Qd7



If 29. Qg6?? fxg6 30. hxg6+ Bh3 and the queen on d7 protects the bishop.

29. Rh4! black resigns.

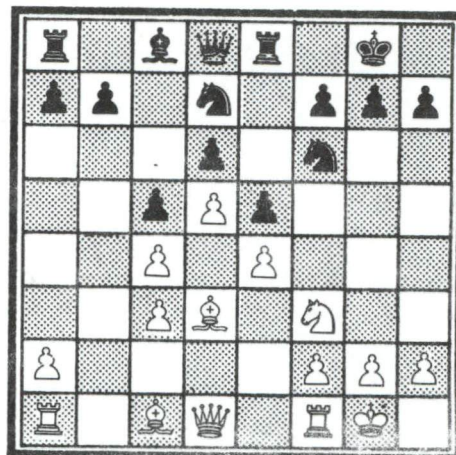
Now 30. Qg6 has great strength because if 30. ... fxg6, 31. hxg6 is mate, otherwise mate is unstoppable. A game which gave me great confidence.

White: D. Rosenberg
 Black: A. Panchapagesan
 London Under 14 Game 7

1. d4 Nf6
 2. c4 e6
 3. Nc3 Bb4
 4. e3 O-O

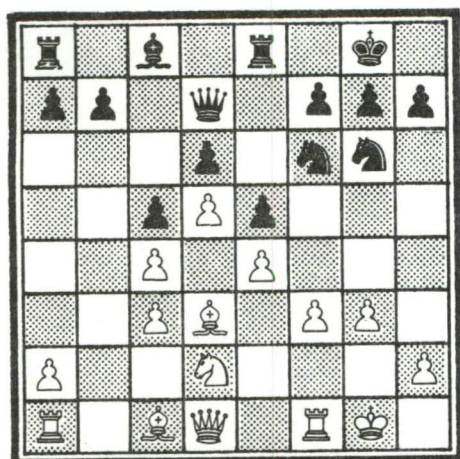
This is the Nimzo-Indian defence, my favourite opening against 1. d4.

5. Bd3 c5
 6. Nf3 d6
 7. O-O Nbd7
 8. e4 Bxc3
 9. bxc3 e5
 10. d5 Re8



I have now, in my opinion, attained complete equality. My plan is to play Nf8-g6-f4.

11. Nd2 preparing a possible f4
 11. ... Nf8
 12. f3 Ng6
 13. g3 stopping my knight going to f4.
 13. ... Qd7



This move possibly hampers my bishop on c8 but my queen is eyeing h3 as a possible square for an attack. I could probably have played 12. ... Bh3 and followed it up with Qd7 but I was after more.

14. Rf2 h5

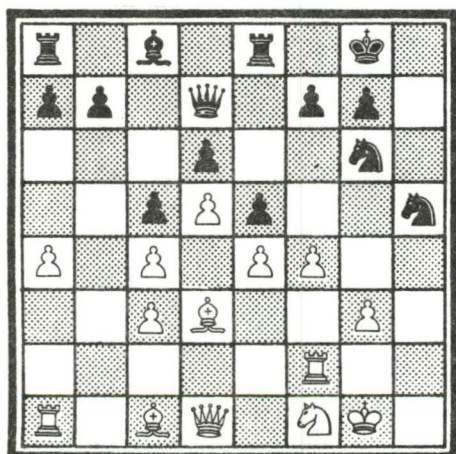
I want to advance this pawn down the board to open up his kingside.

15. Nf1 His plan is to play Ne3 and Nf5.

15. ... h4
16. a4 Nh5?

I did not notice what was in store for me.

17. f4! hxg3
18. hxg3



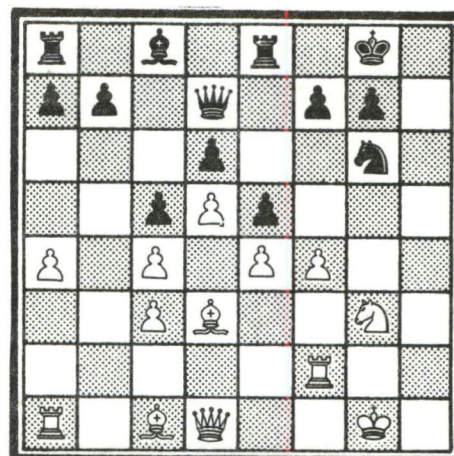
Of course, if 18. Qxh5 gxf2+ wins.

18. ... Nxg3!?

If 18 ... Nf6, 19. f5 and white has a very good position as black is cramped. If 18. ... Qh3, 19. Rh2. If 18. ... Qg4

19. Be2. Both Rh2 and Be2 win the knight on h5. 18. ... Nxg3 cannot work but it is worth a try.

19. Nxg3?!



19. f5 was probably stronger.

19. ... Qh3
20. f5!

A good move cramping black's position.

If 20. ... Qxg3+ 21. Rg2 and 22. fxc6
If white played 20. Rg2 Nh4 and if 20. Rf3 Bg4!

20. ... Nh4
21. Nh5 Kh8 preparing for g6, for

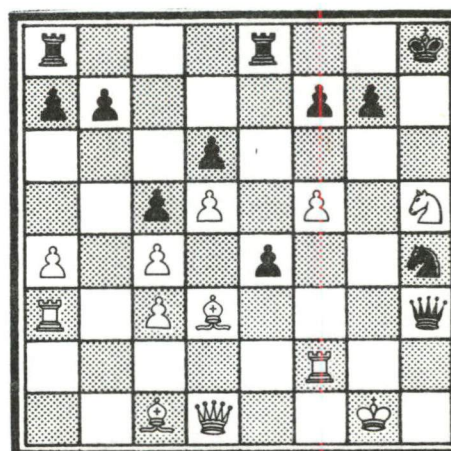
if 21. ... g6 22. Nf6+

22. Ra3 preparing Bf1 winning at least a knight.

22. ... Bxf5!

The only move to get some play. If 23. Bf1 Qg4. Black has a piece for 3 pawns and white's rook on a3 is not doing much.

23. exf5 e4!



Starting a very powerful counterattack

24. Be2 If 24. Bf1, Nf3+

24. ... Nf3+

25. Bxf3

25. Rxf3, exf3 26. Bxf3 Qxf5 was also possible

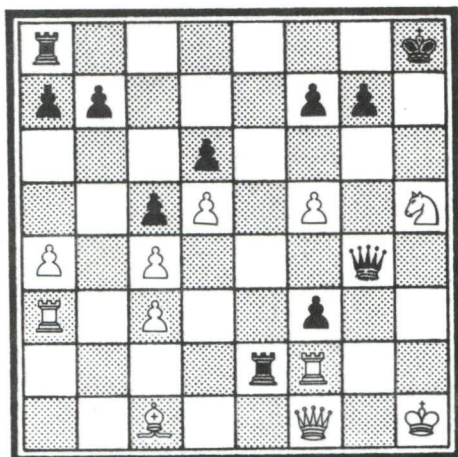
25. ... exf3

26. Qf1

If 26. Rxf3 Qxh5. If 25. Qxf3 Re1+ winning.

26. ... Qg4+

27. Kh1 Re2!



If 27. ... Qxh5+. Rh2 wins the black queen.

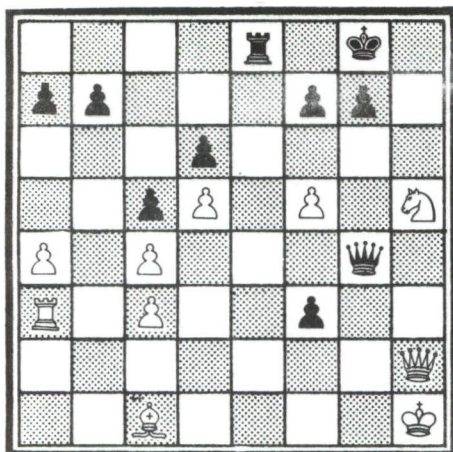
28. Rh2 Kg8

29. Qg1 Rxh2!

30. Qxh2

If 30. Kxh2, Qh4++

30. ... Re8! threatening 31. ... Re1++



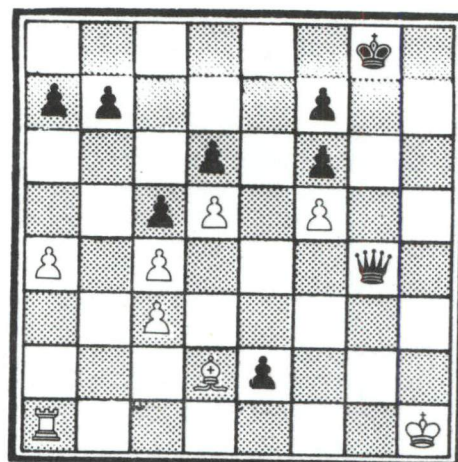
31. Bd2 Re2!

32. Nf6+ gxf6

33. Qxe2 fxe2

If 33. Qg1, Rg2 wins

34. Ra1 threatening Rg1



34. ... Kf8

35. Rg1

Although white is already lost, this is suicide

35. ... Qh3++

Probably my best game of the tournament.

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